CHAPTER 14

TEST CODE READABILITY

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METHODS FOR TEST READABILITY

Readable Tests

Readable Errors

Simple Tests

Test Naming

Test-Friendly Code

Balancing

WHY MAKE READABLE TESTS?

Arowwai Industries

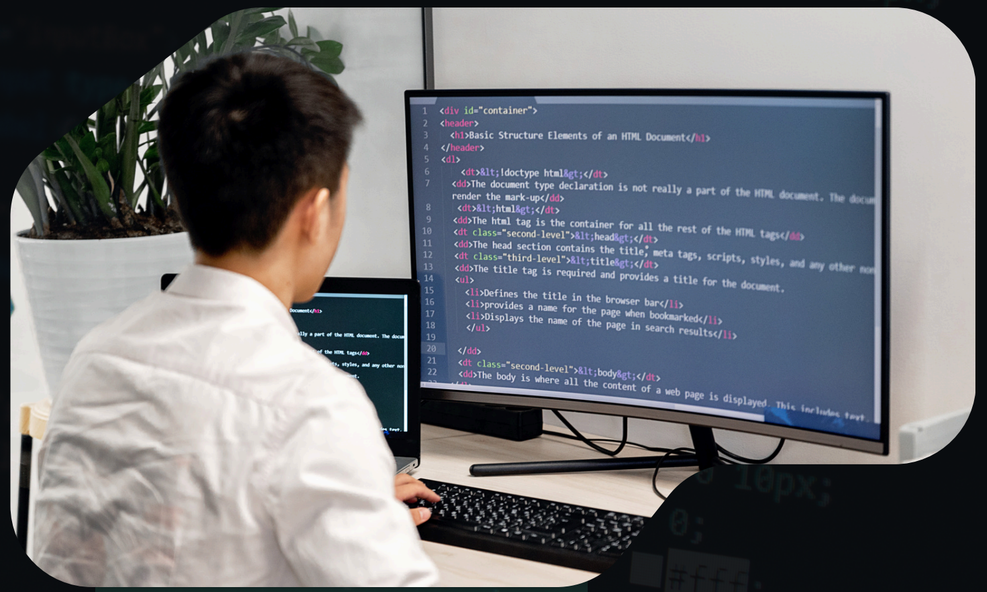
Readable tests make code easier to understand, maintain, debug, and expand.

READABLE TESTS

Hide unimportant details
ex. repetitive code, test details that are constant

Code from thoughts
Describe what you expect your tests to do, ex. what kinds of inputs to take, what kinds of outputs to return

Helper functions
Create small, isolated functions that serve a simple purpose and manages other oddities and conventions (ex. CSV-to-vector converter)



READABLE ERRORS

Give obvious error returns

Make it so that errors provide clear and obvious diagnostics, ex. returning its input, output, and expected value.

SIMPLE TESTS

Make bare minimum tests

Make tests that check for simple and separate cases, ex. for a sort and filter function, check sort and filter functionality separately

TEST NAMING

Give tests obvious names

Don’t give tests names like “Test()” or “Test2()”. Make it clear what your test is doing.

Ex:

- Test_SortAndFilterDocs_BasicSorting()
- Test_SortAndFilterDocs_NegativeValues()

TEST-FRIENDLY CODE

Simple, modular functions

Make functions do one simple thing instead of doing many things, so that diagnosing issues become easier

Minimize interconnectivity

Simplify code interconnectivity/make simple linker functions

Minimize internal state

Internal states (ex. class variables) and global variables may cause functions to behave unpredictably

TEST-FRIENDLY CODE

BALANCING

DON'T FOCUS TOO MUCH ON TEST READABILITY

Your code should be readable in general, not just your tests. Don't expect your tests to have 100% coverage either, i.e. just make it good enough.

THANKS